

Need to use a proper script for Samskritam

Even though Bhagavan understands all languages, the power of our Bharatiya languages cannot be matched in expressing our cultural values especially when rising to the plane of conversing with Bhagavan. Of them, the Samskrita bhasha is special in that it is pan-Bharatiya. Hence our scriptures, anushtana paddhati-s and a lot of bhakti sahitya texts are in Samskrita only.

We know that in Samskritam, especially for anushtanam, sound/pronunciation is important. Therefore one should write and read sankalpa shloka-s etc for anushtanam in an appropriate script which is capable of distinguishing all the sounds of Samskritam.

Now the Latin (English) script was evolved for other languages, and we all know the difficulty of correlating spelling and pronunciation even in English. Further, more letters are required to write Samskritam than English as there are more sounds in it. However, since Latin script is widely known, scholars felt it useful to create a Latin-based transliteration system for Samskritam.

In such a system, Latin letters which may be casually applied to different sounds need to be differentiated. For instance in Rama the first or second “a” may denote a long sound. This is differentiated as Rāma or Ramā. Similarly, other marks called diacritics are used to differentiate sounds as in ā ī ū ṛ ṝ ṝ̄ ṁ ṁ̄ ṁ̄̄ ṇ ṇ̄ ṇ̄̄ ṭ ṭ̄ ṭ̄̄ ṣ ṣ̄. Aspirated (mahāprāna) sounds are denoted with an additional h as in k/kh, g/gh, c/ch, j/jh, ṭ/ṭh, ḍ/ḍh, t/th, d/dh, p/ph, b/bh.

However, a system is useful only if followed correctly. If diacritics or added h-s are ignored and we do not read with the intended pronunciation, then the transliteration is no longer useful for its intended purpose. It is very easy to ignore diacritics as they are not in daily use. It would then have altogether been better to use a script which actually has different symbols for the sounds.

Therefore it is strongly recommended to learn a Bharatiya script like Devanagari, Grantha, Telugu, Kannada etc which has clearly different letters to denote the various sounds. Our documents are published in many such scripts.

However, with a view to help people who are not able to immediately learn such scripts, we are now publishing documents in Latin transliteration as well as per the system called International Alphabet of Sanskrit Transliteration (IAST). For the above reasons, people should use these as a temporary measure till they learn a Bharatiya script.

The Samskrita varnamala in IAST is given below with Devanagari equivalents:

a अ, ā आ, i इ, ī ई, u उ, ū ऊ, ṛ ऋ, ṝ ॠ, ḷ लृ, ḹ ॡ

e ए, ai ऐ, o ओ, au औ, am अं, aḥ अः

ka क, kha ख, ga ग, gha घ, ṇa ङ

ca च, cha छ, ja ज, jha झ, ña ञ

ṭa ट, ṭha ठ, ḍa ड, ḍha ढ, ṇa ण

ta त, tha थ, da द, dha ध, na न

pa प, pha फ, ba ब, bha भ, ma म

ya य, ra र, la ल, va व, śa श, ṣa ष, sa स, ha ह

hara hara śaṅkara

om

jaya jaya śaṅkara



śrī-vedavyāsāya namaḥ

śrīmad-ādyā-śaṅkara-bhagavatpāda-
paramparāgata-mūlāmnāya-sarvajña-pīṭham
śrī-kāñcī-kāmakōṭi-pīṭham
jagadguru-śrī-śaṅkarācārya-svāmi-śrīmaṭha-
samsthānam

viśvarūpa-yātrā

Vishwarupa Yatra

The Chaturmasya Vrata of Paramahansa sannyasis starts near the Vyasa Puja that they perform on Ashadha Purnima. This is completed with Vishwarupa Yatra on Bhadrapada Purnima. Since the restriction is followed so far that the boundary of the village/town or river should not be crossed, Vishwarupa Yatra refers to crossing one such boundary on that day.

The tradition followed in the Shrī Ādya Shankara Bhagavatpāda Pratishtāpita Mūlāmnāya Sarvajna Pītam Shri Kanchi Kamakoti Pītam is as follows: The Pūjyashri Jagadguru Shankarācārya Swamigal will start on the Vishvarūpa Yātrā surrounded by other sannyāsī-s, scholars, students and other devotees. They will cross the boundary and go to some nearby holy spot such as a temple. There, puja will be done to Bhagavad Gītā pustaka as Shrī Krishna, and the Āchārya Swamigal Himself will read the 11th adhyāya of Gītā called Vishvarūpa Darshana Yoga. Then prasāda will be given to the devotees and the program concludes.

This document is published in the thought that even those who are not able to be in the presence of Pūjyashrī Āchārya Swamigal on Vishvarūpa Yātrā day may

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do this pārayanam and receive Bhagavad Anugraha and Guru Anugraha.

Herein, three sections from Mahābhārata where Bhagavān gave Vishvarūpa darshanam in different contexts to different devotees are included. These are:

1. When He was teaching the Gītā, Bhagavān showed Vishvarūpa at the beginning of the Yuddha by the request of Arjuna. This is the well known one. Bhagavān says “I am showing this due to being pleased with you”. This is in the Bhīshma Parva of the Mahābhārata.
2. When Bhagavān went as the emissary of the Pāndava-s to the court of Dhritarāshtra before the Yuddha desiring to prevent it, Duryodhana thinks to jail Bhagavān. At that time, in an attempt to instill good thoughts in them, Bhagavān showed the Vishvarūpa even to the dushta-s Duryodhana etc in that court. This is there in the Udyoga Parva of the Mahābhārata.
3. Nārada went to Shveta Dvīpa on the banks of the Kshīra Sāgara, and praised and prayed of Him. Bhagavān then showed him the Vishvarūpa. This happened some time long ago. In the Shānti Parva of the Mahābhārata, Bhīshma recounts this to Yudhishtira.

The connection of all three above Vishvarūpa Darshana-s with our Kāmakoti Āchārya-s is:

1. We mentioned that the first Vishvarūpa Darshana is read out in the Vishvarūpa Yātra.
2. An anugraha was done by the Jagadguru Shrī Chandrashekharendra Sarasvatī Shankarāchārya Mahaswami on a Vishvarūpa Yātrā day only by connecting the Pāndava Dūta Vishnu temple in Kānchīpuram with the second Vishvarūpa Darshana. This is mentioned in the issue of the Kāmakoti Pradīpam magazine dated 16/11/1964. That article is attached to the end of this document.
3. In the third occasion, there is a verse “

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māyā hyeṣā mayā sṛṣṭā yanmāṃ paśyasi nārada|
sarvabhūtaguṇairyuktaṃ naivaṃ tvam jñāatumarhasi||1||

” in the place where Bhagavān gives extensive jñāna upadesha to Nārada after the Vishvarūpa Darshana. This has been quoted by Jagadguru Shrī Paramashivendra Sarasvatī Shankarāchārya Mahaswami, our 57th Pītādhipati, in His work the Dahara Vidyā Prakāshikā.

There is the saying “mahattvād bhāravattvācca mahābhārataṃ ucyate” that is, “It is called Mahābhārata because it is mahat or exalted and bhāravat or weighty in thoughts”. On this good day of our Shrīcharana-s completing the Chāturmāsya Vrata and starting on Vishvarūpa Yātrā, let us also read the passages shown by Them in such a Mahābhārata, and thereby be benefited!



bhagavadgītāntargataḥ viśvarūpadarśanādhyāyaḥ

arjuna uvāca

madanugrahāya paramaṃ guhyamadhyātmasaṃjñitam|
yat tvayoktaṃ vacastena moho'yaṃ vigato mama||1||

bhavāpyayau hi bhūtānāṃ śrutau vistaraśo mayā|
tvattaḥ kamalapatrākṣa mātmyamapi cāvyayam||2||

evametadyathā”ttha tvamātmānaṃ parameśvara|
draṣṭumicchāmi te rūpamaśvaram puruṣottama||3||

manyase yadi tacchakyaṃ mayā draṣṭumiti prabho|
yogeśvara tato me tvam darśayātmānamavyayam||4||

śrībhagavānuvāca

paśya me pārtha rūpāṇi śataśo'tha sahasraśaḥ|
nānāvidhāni divyāni nānāvarṇākṛtīni ca||5||

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paśyādityān vasūn rudrānaśvinau marutastathā|
bahūnyadr̥ṣṭapūrvāṇi paśyāścaryāṇi bhārata||6||

ihaikasthaṃ jagat kṛtsnaṃ paśyādya sacarācaram|
mama dehe guḍākeśa yaccānyad draṣṭumicchasi||7||

na tu mām śakyase draṣṭumanenaiva svacakṣuṣā|
divyaṃ dadāmi te cakṣuḥ paśya me yogamaiśvaram||8||

sañjaya uvāca

evamuktvā tato rājan mahāyogeśvaro hariḥ|
darśayāmāsa pāṛthāya paramaṃ rūpamaiśvaram||9||

anekavaktranayanamanekādbhutadarśanam |
anekadivyaḥbharāṇaṃ divyānekodyatāyudham||10||

divyamālyāmbaradharam divyagandhānulepanam|
sarvāścaryamayam devamanantaṃ viśvatomukham||11||

divi sūryasahasrasya bhaved yugapadutthitā|
yadi bhāḥ sadṛśī sā syād bhāṣastasya mahātmanaḥ||12||

tatraikasthaṃ jagat kṛtsnaṃ pravibhaktamanekadhā|
apaśyad devadevasya śarīre pāṇḍavastadā||13||

tataḥ sa vismayāviṣṭo hr̥ṣṭaromā dhanañjayaḥ|
praṇamya śirasā devaṃ kṛtāñjalirabhāṣata||14||

arjuna uvāca

paśyāmi devāṃstava deva dehe
sarvāṃstathā bhūtaviśeṣasaṅghān|
brahmāṇamīśaṃ kamalāsanastham
ṛṣīmśca sarvānuragāmśca divyān||15||

anekabāhūdaravaktranetram
paśyāmi tvāṃ sarvato'nantarūpam|
nāntaṃ na madhyaṃ na punastavā'dim
paśyāmi viśveśvara viśvarūpa||16||

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kirīṭinaṃ gadināṃ cakriṇāṃ ca
 tejorāśiṃ sarvato dīptimantam|
 paśyāmi tvāṃ durnirīkṣyaṃ samantāt
 dīptānalārkaḍyutimaprameyam||17||

tvamakṣaraṃ paramaṃ veditavyam
 tvamasya viśvasya paraṃ nidhānam|
 tvamavyayaḥ śāśvatadharmagoptā
 sanātanastvaṃ puruṣo mato me||18||

anādimadhyāntamanantavīryam
 anantabāhuṃ śaśisūryanetram|
 paśyāmi tvāṃ dīptahutāśavaktram
 svatejasā viśvamidaṃ tapantam||19||

dyāvāpṛthivyoridamantaram hi
 vyāptam tvayaikena diśaśca sarvāḥ|
 drṣṭvā'dbhutam rūpamugram tavedam
 lokatrayaṃ pravyathitam mahātman||20||

amī hi tvāṃ surasaṅghā viśanti
 kecid bhītāḥ prāñjalayo grṇanti|
 svastītyuktvā maharṣisiddhasaṅghāḥ
 stuvanti tvāṃ stutibhiḥ puṣkalābhiḥ||21||

rudrādityā vasavo ye ca sādhyāḥ
 viśve'svinau marutaścoṣmapāśca|
 gandharvayakṣāsurasiddhasaṅghāḥ
 vīkṣante tvāṃ vismitāścaiva sarve||22||

rūpaṃ mahat te bahuvaktranetram
 mahābāho bahubāhūrupādam|
 bahūdaram bahudaṃṣṭrākārālam
 drṣṭvā lokāḥ pravyathitāstathā'ham||23||

nabhaḥsprśaṃ dīptamanekavarṇam
 vyāttānaṃ dīptaviśālanetram|
 drṣṭvā hi tvāṃ pravyathitāntarātmā
 dhṛtiṃ na vindāmi śamaṃ ca viṣṇo||24||

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daṁṣṭrākarālāni ca te mukhāni
 dṛṣṭvaiva kālānalasannibhāni|
 diśo na jāne na labhe ca śarma
 prasīda deveśa jagannivāsa||25||
 amī ca tvāṁ dhṛtarāṣṭrasya putrāḥ
 sarve sahaivāvanipālasaṅghaiḥ|
 bhīṣmo droṇaḥ sūtaputrastathā'sau
 sahāsmadīyairapi yodhamukhyaiḥ||26||
 vaktrāṇi te tvaramāṇā viśanti
 daṁṣṭrākarālāni bhayānakāni|
 kecid vilagnā daśanāntareṣu
 sandṛśyante cūrṇitairuttamāṅgaiḥ||27||
 yathā nadīnāṁ bahavo'mbuvegāḥ
 samudramevābhimukhā dravanti|
 tathā tavāmī naralokavīrāḥ
 viśanti vaktrāṇyabhivijvalanti||28||
 yathā pradīptam jvalanam pataṅgāḥ
 viśanti nāśāya samṛddhavegāḥ|
 tathaiva nāśāya viśanti lokāḥ
 tavāpi vaktrāṇi samṛddhavegāḥ||29||
 lelihyase grasamānaḥ samantāt
 lokān samagrān vadanairjvaladbhiḥ|
 tejobhirāpūrya jagat samagram
 bhāsaṣṭavogrāḥ pratapanti viṣṇo||30||
 ākhyāhi me ko bhavānugrarūpaḥ
 namo'stu te devavara prasīda|
 vijñātumicchāmi bhavantamādyam
 na hi prajānāmi tava pravṛttim||31||

śrībhagavānuvāca

kālo'smi lokakṣayakṛt pravṛddhaḥ
 lokān samāhartumiha pravṛttaḥ|
 rte'pi tvāṁ na bhaviṣyanti sarve
 ye'vasthitāḥ pratyānīkeṣu yodhāḥ||32||
 veda-dharma-śāstra-paripālana-sabhā

tasmāt tvamuttiṣṭha yaśo labhasva
 jītvā śātrūn bhuṅkṣva rājyaṃ samṛddham|
 mayaivaite nihaṭāḥ pūrvameva
 nimittamātraṃ bhava savyasācin||33||

droṇaṃ ca bhīṣmaṃ ca jayadrathaṃ ca
 karṇaṃ tathā'nyānapi yodhavīrān|
 mayā hatāṃstvaṃ jahi mā vyathiṣṭhāḥ
 yudhyasva jetāsi raṇe sapatnān||34||

sañjaya uvāca

etacchrutvā vacanaṃ keśavasya
 kṛtāñjalirvepamānaḥ kirīṭi|
 namaskṛtvā bhūya evāha kṛṣṇaṃ
 sagadgadaṃ bhītabhītaḥ praṇamya||35||

arjuna uvāca

sthāne hr̥ṣīkeśa tava prakīrtyā
 jagat prahr̥ṣyatyanurajyate ca|
 rakṣāṃsi bhītāni diśo dravanti
 sarve namasyanti ca siddhasaṅghāḥ||36||

kasmācca te na nameran mahātman
 garīyase brahmaṇo'pyādikartre|
 ananta deveśa jagannivāsa
 tvamakṣaraṃ sadasat tatparaṃ yat||37||

tvamādidēvaḥ puruṣaḥ purāṇaḥ
 tvamasya viśvasya paraṃ nidhānam|
 vettā'si vedyam ca paraṃ ca dhāma
 tvayā tataṃ viśvamanantarūpa||38||

vāyuryamo'gnirvaruṇaḥ śaśāṅkaḥ
 prajāpatistvaṃ prapitāmahaśca|
 namo namaste'stu sahasrakṛtvaḥ
 punaśca bhūyo'pi namo namaste||39||

namaḥ purastādatha pṛṣṭhataste
 namo'stu te sarvata eva sarva|
 anantavīryāmitavikramastvam
 sarvaṃ samāpnoṣi tato'si sarvaḥ||40||
 sakheti matvā prasabhaṃ yaduktam
 he kṛṣṇa he yādava he sakheti|
 ajānatā mahimānaṃ tavedam
 mayā pramādāt praṇayena vā'pi||41||
 yaccāvahāsārthamasatkṛto'si
 vihāraśayyāsanabhojaneṣu |
 eko'thavā'pyacyuta tat samakṣam
 tat kṣāmaye tvāmahamaprameyam||42||
 pitā'si lokasya carācarasya
 tvamasya pūjyaśca gururgarīyān|
 na tvatsamo'styabhyadhikaḥ kuto'nyaḥ
 lokatraye'pyapratimaprabhāva ||43||
 tasmāt praṇamya praṇidhāya kāyam
 prasādaye tvāmahamīśamīḍyam|
 piteva putrasya sakheva sakhyuḥ
 priyaḥ priyāyārhasi deva soḍhum||44||
 adṛṣṭapūrvam hr̥ṣito'smi dṛṣṭvā
 bhayena ca pravyathitaṃ mano me|
 tadeva me darśaya deva rūpam
 prasīda deveśa jagannivāsa||45||
 kirīṭinaṃ gadinam cakrahastam
 icchāmi tvāṃ draṣṭumahaṃ tathaiva|
 tenaiva rūpeṇa caturbhujena
 sahasrabāho bhava viśvamūrte||46||

śrībhagavānuvāca

mayā prasannena tavārjunedam
 rūpaṃ paraṃ darśitamātmayogāt|
 tejomayaṃ viśvamanantamādyam
 yanme tvadanyena na dṛṣṭapūrvam||47||
 veda-dharma-śāstra-paripālana-sabhā

na vedayajñādhyayanairna dānaiḥ
 na ca kriyābhirna tapobhirugraiḥ|
 evaṁrūpaḥ śakya ahaṁ nṛloke
 draṣṭuṁ tvadanyena kurupravīra||48||
 mā te vyathā mā ca vimūḍhabhāvaḥ
 drṣṭvā rūpaṁ ghoramīdṛṇmamedam|
 vyapetabhīḥ prītaṁāṇaḥ punastvam
 tadeva me rūpamidaṁ prapaśya||49||

sañjaya uvāca

ityarjunaṁ vāsudevastathoktvā
 svakaṁ rūpaṁ darśayāmāsa bhūyaḥ|
 āśvāsayāmāsa ca bhītaṁenaṁ
 bhūtvā punaḥ saumya vapurmahātmā||50||

arjuna uvāca

drṣṭvedaṁ mānuṣaṁ rūpaṁ tava saumyaṁ janārdana|
 idānīmasmi saṁvṛttaḥ sacetāḥ prakṛtiṁ gataḥ||51||

śrībhagavānuvāca

sudurdarśamidaṁ rūpaṁ drṣṭavānasi yanmama|
 devā apyasya rūpasya nityaṁ darśanakāṅkṣiṇaḥ||52||

nāhaṁ vedairna tapasā na dānena na cejyayā|
 śakya evaṁvidho draṣṭuṁ drṣṭavānasi mām yathā||53||

bhaktyā tvaṇanyayā śakya ahamevaṁvidho'rjuna|
 jñātuṁ draṣṭuṁ ca tattvena praveṣṭuṁ ca parantapa||54||

matkarmaḥṇmatparamo madbhaktaḥ saṅgavarjitaḥ|
 nirvairah sarvabhūteṣu yaḥ sa mām eti pāṇḍava||55||

||om tatsaditi śrīmadbhagavadgītāsu upaniṣatsu brahmavidyāyām
 yogaśāstre śrīkṛṣṇārjunasaṁvāde viśvarūpadarśanayogo nāma ekā-
 daśo'dhyāyaḥ||

|| iti śrīmanmahābhārata vaiyāsikyāṁ śatasāhasryāṁ saṁhitāyāṁ bhīṣma-
 parvaṇi (bhagavadgītāparvaṇi) pañcatrimśo* 'dhyāyaḥ ||

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* = nirṇayasāgara-prakāśita-dākṣiṇātya-pāṭhānusāram



bhagavatā kauravasabhāyām viśvarūpasya pradarśanam

vaiśampāyana uvāca

vidureṇaivamukte tu keśavaḥ parapūgahā|
duryodhanaṁ dhārtarāṣṭram abhyabhāṣata vīryavān||1||

śrībhagavānuvāca

eko'hamiti yanmohānmanyase mām suyodhana|
paribhūya sudurbuddhe grahītuṁ mām cikīrṣasi||2||

ihaiva pāṇḍavāssarve tathaivāndhakavṛṣṇayaḥ|
ihādityāśca rudrāśca vasavaśca maharṣibhiḥ||3||

vaiśampāyana uvāca

evamuktvā jahāsoccaiḥ keśavaḥ paravīrahā|
tasya saṁsmayataḥ śaurervidyudrūpā mahātmanah||4||

yugapacca viniṣpetuḥ sākṣāt sarvāstu devatāḥ|
aṅguṣṭhamātrāstridaśā babhūvuḥ pāvakārciṣaḥ||5||

tasya brahmā lalāṭastho rudro vakṣasi cābhavat|
lokapālā bhujeṣvāsannagnirāsyādajāyata||6||

ādityāścaiva sādhyāśca vasavo'thāśvināvapi|
marutaśca sahendreṇa viśve devāstathaiva ca||7||

babhūvuścaiva yakṣāśca gandharvoragarākṣasāḥ|
prādurāstām tadā dorbhyām saṅkarṣaṇadhanañjayau||8||

dakṣiṇe cārjuno dhanvī halī rāmaśca savyataḥ|
bhīmo yudhiṣṭhiraścaiva mādriputrau ca prṣṭhataḥ||9||

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andhakā vṛṣṇayaścaiva pradyumnapramukhāstataḥ|
agre babhūvuḥ kṛṣṇasya samudyatamahāyudhāḥ||10||

śaṅkhacakraḡadāśaktiśārṅgalāṅgalanandakāḥ|
adrśyantodyatāṇyeva sarvapraharāṇāni ca||11||

nānā bāhuṣu kṛṣṇasya dīpyamānāni sarvaśaḥ|
netrābhyāṃ nāsikābhyāṃ ca śrotrābhyāṃ ca samantataḥ||12||

prādurāsan mahāraudrāḥ sadhūmāḥ pāvakārciṣaḥ|
romakūpeṣu ca tathā sūryasyeva marīcayaḥ||13||

sahasracaraṇaḥ śrīmān śatabāhuḥ sahasradṛk|
tasya vai nāgalokaśca gulphādho dadṛṣe tadā||14||

candrasūryau tathā netre grahā vai sarvataḥ sthitāḥ|
ūrdhvalokaśca sarve'pi kukṣau tasya vyavasthitāḥ||15||

saritaḥ sāgarāścaiva svedastasya mahātmanah|
asthīni parvatāḥ sarve vṛkṣā romāṇi tasya hi||16||

nimeṣaṇaṃ rātryahanī jihvāyāṃ śāradā tathā|
taṃ drṣṭvā ghoramātmānaṃ keśavasya mahātmanah||17||

nyamīlayanta netrāṇi rājānastrastacetasaḥ|
ṛte droṇaṃ ca bhīṣmaṃ ca viduraṃ ca mahāmatim||18||

sañjayaṃ ca mahābhāgaṃ ṛṣīmścaiva tapodhanān|
prādāt teṣāṃ sa bhagavān divyaṃ cakṣurjanārdanaḥ||19||

dhṛtarāṣṭrāya pradadau bhagavān divyacakṣuṣī|
dadarśa paramaṃ rūpaṃ dhṛtarāṣṭro'mbikāsutaḥ||20||

tato devāḥ sagandharvāḥ kinnarāśca mahoragāḥ|
ṛṣayaśca mahābhāgā lokapālaiḥ samanvitāḥ|
praṇamya śirasā devaṃ tuṣṭuvuḥ prāñjali sthitāḥ||21||

krodhaṃ prabho saṃhara saṃhara svam
rūpaṃ ca yad darśitamātmasaṃstham|
yāvat tvime devagaṇaiḥ sametāḥ
lokāḥ samastā bhuvi nāsamīyuh||22||

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tvam ca kartā vikartā ca tvameva parirakṣase|
tvayā vyāptamidaṁ sarvaṁ jagat sthāvarajaṅgamam||23||

kiyanmātrā mahīpālāḥ kiṁvīryāḥ kiṁparākramāḥ|
teṣāmarthe mahābāho divyaṁ rūpaṁ pradarśivān||24||

tad drṣṭvā mahadāścaryaṁ mādhavasya sabhātale|
devadundubhayo neduḥ puṣpavarṣaṁ papāta ca||25||

dhṛtarāṣṭra uvāca

tvameva puṇḍarīkākṣa sarvasya jagataḥ prabhuḥ|
tasmānme yādavaśreṣṭha prasādaṁ kartumarhasi||26||

devadeva mahāyogin vāsudeva janārdana|
bhagavan mama netrābhyām antardhānaṁ vṛṇe punaḥ|
bhavantam drṣṭavānasmī nānyaṁ draṣṭumihotsahe||27||

vaiśampāyana uvāca

tato'bravīnmahābāhurdhṛtarāṣṭraṁ janārdanaḥ|

śrībhagavānuvāca

adrśyamāne netre dve bhavetām kurunandana||28||

vaiśampāyana uvāca

tatrādbhutaṁ mahārāja dhṛtarāṣṭraśca cakṣuṣī|
labdhavān vāsudevasya viśvarūpadidrṁkṣayā||29||

labdhacakṣuṣamāsīnaṁ dhṛtarāṣṭraṁ narādhipāḥ|
vismitā ṛṣibhiḥ sārdhaṁ tuṣṭuvurmadhusūdanam||30||

cacāla ca mahī kṛtsnā sāgaraścāpi cukṣubhe|
vismayaṁ paramaṁ jagmuḥ pārthivā bharatarṣabha||31||

tataḥ sa puruṣavyāghraḥ sañjahāra vapuḥ svakam|
tām divyāmadbhutaṁ citrām ṛddhimattāmarindamaḥ||32||

tataḥ sātyakimādāya pāṇau vidurameva ca|
ṛṣibhistairanujñāto niryayau madhusūdanaḥ||33||

veda-dharma-śāstra-paripālana-sabhā

ṛṣayo'ntarhitā jagmustataste nāradādayaḥ|
tasmin kolāhale vṛtte tadadbhutamivābhavat||34||

|| iti śrīmanmahābhārata vaiyāsikyāṃ śatasāhasryāṃ saṃhitāyāṃ udyo-
gaparvaṇi (bhagavadyaṇaparvaṇi) ekatrimśadadhikaśatatame* 'dhyāye
viśvarūpadarśanam ||

* = nirṇayasāgara-prakāśita-dākṣiṇātya-pāṭhānusāram



bhagavatā kṣīrasāgarataṭe vidyamāne śvetadvīpe nāradāya viśvarūpasya pradarśanam

bhīṣma uvāca

evam stutaḥ sa bhagavān guhyaistathyaiva nāmabhiḥ|
bhagavān viśvasṛkṣiṃhaḥ sarvamūrtimayaḥ prabhuḥ|
darśayāmāsa munaye rūpaṃ tatparamaṃ hariḥ||1||

kiñciccandrād viśuddhātmā kiñciccandrād viśeṣavān|
krśānuvarṇaḥ kiñcicca kiñcid dhiṣṇyākṛtiḥ prabhuḥ||2||

śukapatranibhaḥ kiñcit kiñcit sphaṭikasannibhaḥ|
nīlāñjanacayaprakhyo jātarūpaprabhaḥ kvacit ||3||

pravālāṅkuravarṇaśca śvetavarṇastathā kvacit|
kvacit suvarṇavarṇābho vaidūryasadrśaḥ kvacit ||4||

nīlavaidūryasadrśa indranīlanibhaḥ kvacit|
mayūragrīvavarṇābho muktāhāranibhaḥ kvacit ||5||

etān bahuvidhān varṇān rūpairbibhṛat sanātanāḥ|
sahasranayanāḥ śrīmān śataśīrṣaḥ sahasrapāt||6||

sahasrodarabāhuśca avyakta iti ca kvacit|
oṃkāramudgiran vaktrāt sāvitṛiṃ ca tadanvayām||7||

śeṣebhyaścaiva vaktrebhyaścaturvedān giran vahan|
āraṇyakam jagau devo harirnārāyaṇo vaśī||8||

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vedim kamaṇḍalum darbhānmaṇirūpāmstathā kuśān|
ajinaṁ daṇḍakāṣṭhaṁ ca jvalitaṁ ca hutāśanam||9||

dhārayāmāsa deveśo hastairyajñapatistadā|
taṁ prasannaṁ prasannātmā nārado dvijasattamaḥ||10||

vāgyataḥ praṇato bhūtvā vavande parameśvaram|
tamuvāca nataṁ mūrdhnā devānāmādiravyayaḥ||11||

śrībhagavānuvāca

ekataśca dvitaścaiva tritaścaiva maharṣayaḥ|
imaṁ deśamanuprāptā mama darśanalālasāḥ||12||

na ca mām te dadṛśire na ca drakṣyati kaścana|
ṛte hyaikāntikaśreṣṭhāt tvaṁ caivaikāntikottamaḥ||13||

mamaitāstanavaḥ śreṣṭhā jātā dharmagrhe dvija|
tāstvaṁ bhajasva satataṁ sādhasya yathāgatam||14||

|| iti śrīmanmahābhārata vaiyāsikyāṁ śatasāhasryāṁ saṁhitāyām
śāntiparvaṇi (mokṣadharmaparvaṇi nārāyaṇīye) saptacatvāriṁśadadhika-
triśatatame*’dhyāye viśvarūpadarśanam ||

* = nirṇayasāgara-prakāśita-dākṣiṇātya-pāṭhānusāram



The glory of seeing the Vishwarupa during Vishwarupa yatra

[Article published in Shri Kamakoti Pradipam (16/11/1964)]

Last September, on the 22nd, after the first day proceedings of the Vyasa Bharata Vidwat Sadas, I along with Shri T V Vishvanatha Iyer and Shri D Narayana Iyer went to have the darshana of and take leave from Shri Jagadguru Acharya Swamigal with the intent of returning to Chennai. At that time, Shri Swamigal revealed a great truth about the temples at Kanchi to us.

It is customary for Acharyas to undertake the Vishwarupa Yatra on the concluding day of Chaturmasya Vrata. This year, likewise proceeding from Kanchi Matham towards the north

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until the city border, staying in a place for some time, and after doing parayana of the Vishwaroopa adhyaya seen in the Bhagavad Gita, on the way back, apparently He went to the Pandava Duta Peruman temple.

There in that temple, Shri Krishna is seen taking a large and majestic form. Looking at that, Shri Jagadguru thought “Perhaps this depicts Shri Bhagavan’s Vishwarupa?” and while observing keenly, He was reminded of the Vishwaroopa Darshana given by Shri Krishna in the sabha of Dhritarashtra to Duryodhana and others, and immediately sent for the Mahabharata and had that adhyaya chanted.

This is the 131st adhyaya in the Udyoga Parva of Mahabharata. In the Mahabharata, Bhagavan takes Vishwaroopa in two situations. One in the sabha of Dhritarashtra. The other the one shown to Arjuna in the battlefield. It is said in the description of Vishwarupa shown by Bhagavan in this sabha as follows:

nānā bāhuṣu kṛṣṇasya dīpyamānāni sarvaśaḥ
netrābhyāṃ nāsikābhyāṃ ca śrotrābhyāṃ ca samantataḥ ||26||

prādūrāsan mahāraudrāḥ sadhūmāḥ pāvakārciṣaḥ
romakūpeṣu ca tathā sūryasyeva marīcayaḥ ||27||

“Like the rays of the sun, fire issued forth from the hair follicles of Krishna Bhagavan’s form.”

The Acharya Swamigal said He was astonished to see that to depict this, the entire body of the moola vigraha in the temple was sculpted as if there were flowers all over the body. In those days, they built temples after well knowing the contents of the itihisas and expressed them in the vigrahas as well.

I have written this with the desire that everyone else should know about this glory.

— K Balasubramania Aiyar